PTUT — FINAL YEAR PROJECT

Weekly Progress Report · Week 3 of 12

TaxWise Freelance

Automated Tax Deductions & Invoicing Platform

High-Level Architecture & Cloud Topology

STUDENT
Muhammad Sohaib Ramzan

SUPERVISOR
Dr. Zaigham Mushtaq

DEPARTMENT
Software Engineering Technology

SECTION
A

PROJECT ID
PTUT-PRJ-042

DOMAIN
FinTech, Personal Wealth & Micro-Finance

REPORTING PERIOD
28 October – 3 November 2026

SUBMITTED
4 November 2026

Source code: github.com/SohaibRamzan01/taxwise-freelance

1. Summary

This week I designed **how the system is built**: the three layers of the app, how data moves between them, where the system ends, and which cloud services will run it.

Task from the plan	Status
3-tier architecture diagram (Client, API Server, Database)	Done — Figure 1
Data Flow Diagram Level 0	Done — Figure 2
Data Flow Diagram Level 1	Done — Figure 3
Define system boundaries	Done — section 5
Justify the cloud infrastructure stack	Done — section 6

2. Three-tier architecture

The app has three layers. Each layer only talks to the layer next to it.

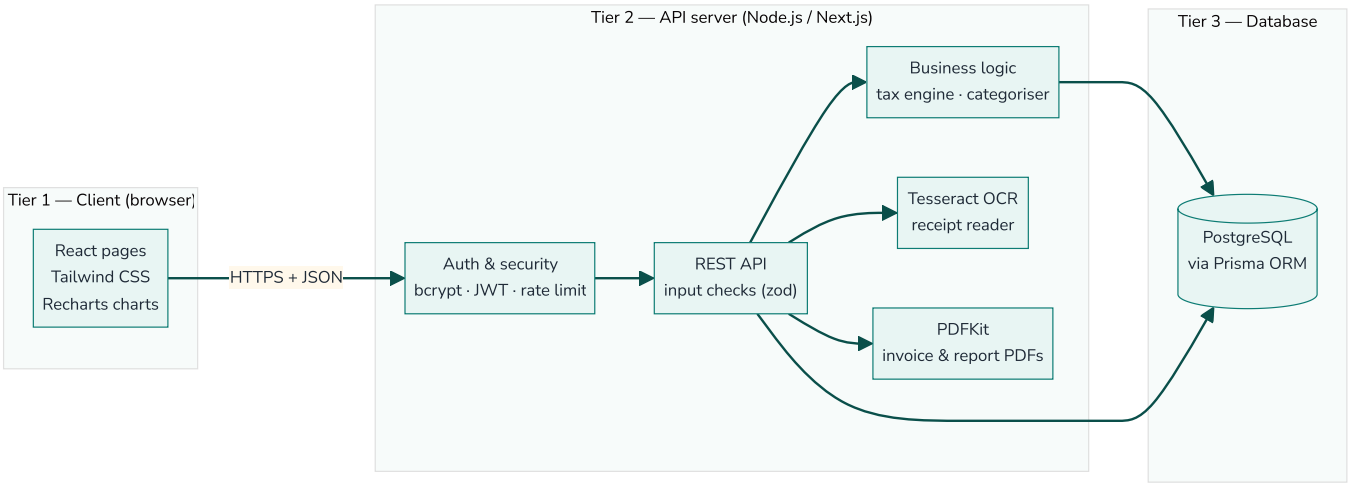


Figure 1 — 3-tier architecture

Tier	Technology	Job
Client	React (Next.js), Tailwind CSS, Recharts	Shows pages, forms and charts in the browser
API server	Node.js (Next.js route handlers), TypeScript	Checks who the user is, validates input, runs tax rules, reads receipts (Tesseract OCR), makes PDFs (PDFKit)
Database	PostgreSQL with Prisma ORM	Stores users, expenses, receipts, income, clients, invoices and tax payments

3. Data Flow Diagram — Level 0 (context)

Level 0 shows the whole system as **one process** and the outside people and services it exchanges data with.

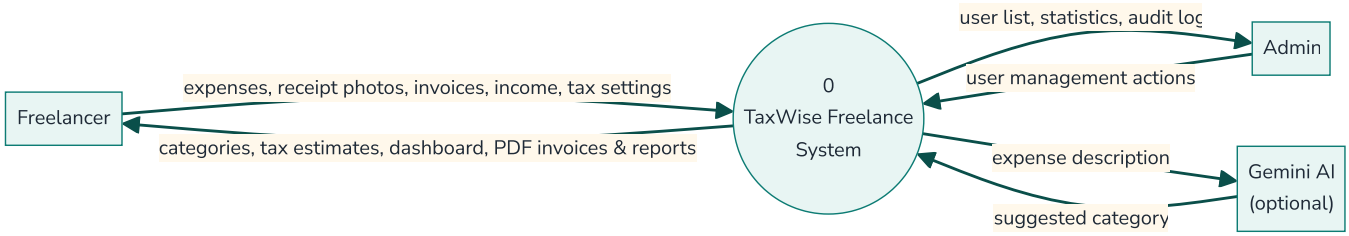


Figure 2 — DFD Level 0 (context diagram)

4. Data Flow Diagram — Level 1

Level 1 opens the system and shows its **main processes** and **data stores**.

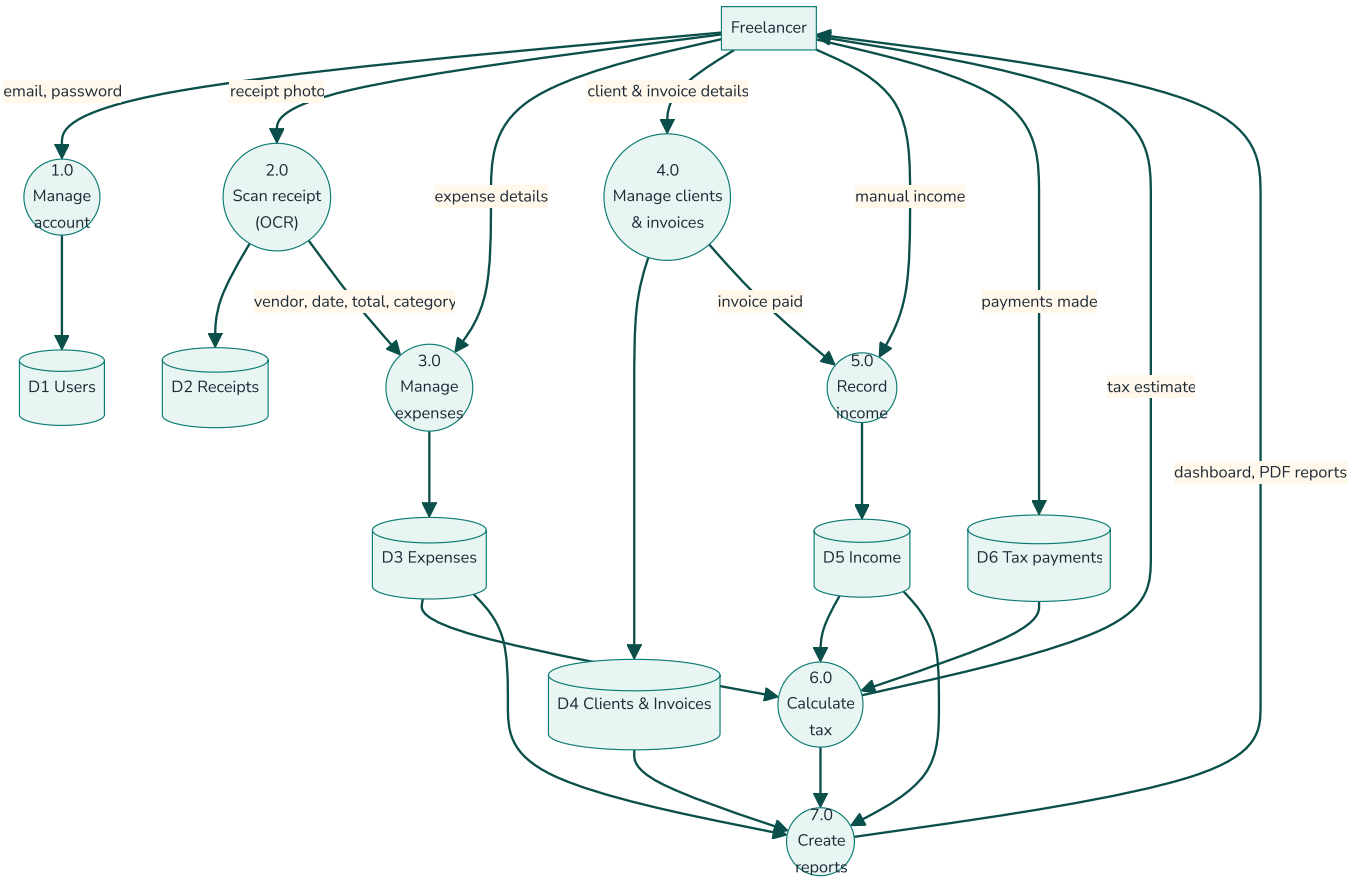


Figure 3 — DFD Level 1

5. System boundaries

Inside the system (we build it): accounts and login, receipt scanning, expenses, income, clients, invoices, tax estimator, dashboard, PDF reports, admin portal.

Outside the system (we only connect to it or leave it out):

- **Gemini AI** — optional helper for categories. If it is down, the app uses its own keyword rules.
- **Banks and payment apps** — not connected. Users record payments themselves.
- **Tax authority (IRS)** — the app does **not** file tax returns.
- **Email** — invoices are downloaded as PDF; the app does not send emails.

Security boundary: every request passes through the login check. Every database query is filtered by the logged-in user's ID, so one user can never see another user's data.

6. Cloud stack and why it was chosen

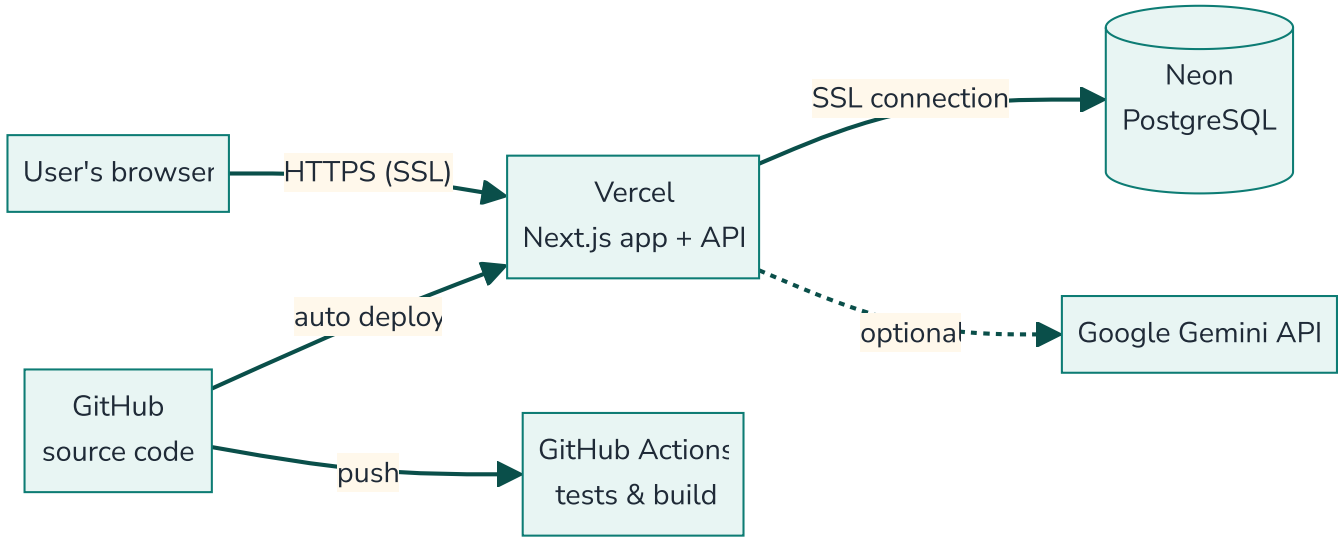


Figure 4 — Cloud deployment

Part	Service	Why	Cost
App + API	**Vercel**	Made for Next.js, free SSL, auto-deploys from GitHub	Free tier
Database	**Neon PostgreSQL**	Real PostgreSQL in the cloud, works well with Vercel	Free tier
Testing pipeline	**GitHub Actions**	Runs tests and build on every push	Free

Part	Service	Why	Cost
AI (optional)	**Google Gemini**	Better category suggestions	Free tier / optional

Total cost: $0. Other options compared: Render, Railway, Supabase and Firebase. Firebase was not chosen because it is not a relational database, and our data (invoices, line items, payments) needs relations and transactions.

7. Challenges and solutions

Challenge	Solution
OCR needs a lot of processing power	Run Tesseract on the server with a time limit; manual entry always available
Free cloud databases sleep when unused	Use Neon's pooled connection; the first request may be a little slower
Must keep users' data separate	Every table has a user ID and every query is filtered by it

8. Plan for next week (Week 4)

- Draw the database Entity-Relationship Diagram (ERD) with indexes.
- Write the full list of REST API endpoints.
- Design wireframes for the main screens.